

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

September 26, 2026

AI Agents Move Into Persistent Workflows and Infrastructure Contracts, While Crypto Faces Security and State-Level Market Rules

Microsoft has introduced a persistent Copilot agent designed to continue work when the user is away, while Anthropic has made a \$11.6 billion, seven-year cloud-services commitment to Akamai. Together, the announcements show that the next AI competition is about dependable execution and the capacity contracts required to support it.

In crypto, Bitget disclosed roughly \$351.6 million in unauthorized hot-wallet transfers, and New York sued Polymarket over its prediction-market operation. Both developments point to a practical reality: custody controls and local legal permissions still determine whether a digital-finance product can be trusted and scaled.

1. Microsoft makes Copilot more persistent with Home, Code and Autopilot

Microsoft · September 25, 2026

Introducing the new Copilot with Home, Code and Autopilot

The story

Microsoft introduced three additions to its Copilot app: Home, which brings chat and collaborative work together; Code, a natural-language way to build solutions using technology related to GitHub Copilot; and Autopilot, a persistent agent intended to keep working when the user is away. Microsoft said the tools will be introduced in stages, with Autopilot expanding to private preview at the end of September.

The product direction changes the expectation for an enterprise assistant. Instead of waiting for a single prompt and response, a persistent agent may hold a task, retrieve information from approved work systems and return with a completed or escalated result. That raises the value of the workflow, but also raises the cost of mistakes.

Why it matters

A persistent agent needs more than a strong model. It needs identity controls, scoped permissions, an audit trail, a clear handoff point and limits on what it can change without approval. Those operational layers decide whether autonomy reduces work or creates a new queue of exceptions.

For buyers, the key metric is not the number of agent sessions. It is the completed-task rate after review, including the time, inference cost and human escalation required to reach a usable outcome.

What to watch

- The scope of Autopilot's access to Microsoft 365 data and external tools.
 - How administrators define approvals, permissions and audit requirements.
 - Evidence that persistent work reduces, rather than shifts, human operations work.
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2. Anthropic's \$11.6 billion Akamai agreement turns AI capacity into a long-term operating commitment

Akamai Technologies · September 24, 2026

Form 8-K: significantly expanded relationship with Anthropic

The story

Akamai said Anthropic agreed to \$11.6 billion of contractual cloud-services commitments over seven years. The company said the relationship could expand by up to another \$9 billion. Reuters reported that the arrangement covers cloud services, underscoring the scale of infrastructure spending behind frontier-model training and inference.

The agreement is notable because it converts expected future compute demand into a contractual commitment. That can help a cloud provider plan capacity and financing, while giving an AI developer access to infrastructure that might otherwise be constrained by supply, delivery schedules or power availability.

Why it matters

AI economics are increasingly shaped by capital expenditure and supply-chain bottlenecks, not only by model quality. Long-duration capacity contracts can make unit costs and availability more predictable, but they also create fixed obligations if demand or model efficiency changes faster than planned.

For the broader market, the deal highlights a move toward institutional distribution of AI infrastructure. Providers with power, network reach, hardware relationships and financing capacity can become strategic partners rather than interchangeable hosting vendors.

What to watch

- Whether the optional expansion is exercised and how capacity is phased in.
- The mix of training and inference workloads behind the agreement.

- Whether efficiency gains lower the need for contracted compute per customer task.

3. Bitget's hot-wallet incident puts custody architecture and loss-absorption claims under scrutiny

Bitget · September 24, 2026

Security Notice: Bitget Hot Wallet Incident

The story

Bitget said it detected unauthorized transfers from some hot wallets on September 24 and estimated the affected funds at about \$351.6 million. The exchange said cold wallets remained secure, temporarily suspended withdrawals while it reviewed the incident and said its User Protection Fund exceeded the estimated loss. The company said it would publish a root-cause report after its investigation.

The incident is a reminder that an exchange balance is a claim on an operating institution, not the same thing as self-custody. Hot wallets are connected to the systems that process activity quickly, which makes them useful for settlement but also creates a concentrated attack surface.

Why it matters

Custody risk depends on wallet segmentation, authorization controls, transaction monitoring, recovery procedures and the legal and financial ability to make customers whole. A protection fund can reduce loss exposure, but its liquidity, governance and terms matter when a stress event occurs.

For institutions, counterparty diligence should include the redemption process during an incident. The relevant question is not only whether an exchange says assets are safe, but how quickly customers can withdraw, reconcile balances and verify the source of recovery funds.

What to watch

- Bitget's root-cause analysis and any independent forensic findings.

- The timetable for restoring withdrawals and any changes to wallet controls.
- Whether recovery, insurance or protection-fund mechanisms cover the final loss in practice.

4. New York's Polymarket lawsuit shows prediction markets still face a state-by-state legal test

Office of the New York Attorney General · September 24, 2026
Attorney General James and Governor Hochul announce lawsuit against Polymarket

The story

New York Attorney General Letitia James and Governor Kathy Hochul announced a lawsuit against Polymarket US, alleging that its prediction-market platform is an illegal, unlicensed gambling operation in the state. The office is seeking an order to stop the business in New York, along with penalties, forfeiture of alleged illegal gains and customer restitution.

Prediction markets can look like financial products because they trade contracts linked to future events. Yet states may apply gambling rules when the underlying activity, customer protection framework or licensing status does not meet their standards. The classification question is therefore inseparable from where and how the service is offered.

Why it matters

Regulatory arbitrage is difficult to sustain when a product crosses state lines. A federal, exchange or technology label does not by itself settle the consumer-protection, licensing and market-conduct rules that a state regulator may enforce.

For platforms, compliance needs to include geographic controls, age verification, market design and a clear legal basis for each distribution channel. For users and investors, jurisdictional risk can affect access, liquidity and the value of a network built around a particular market.

What to watch

- Polymarket's response and any court decision on New York's jurisdiction and claims.
 - Whether other states use similar theories against prediction-market platforms.
 - Changes to geofencing, eligibility checks and market offerings in response to state enforcement.
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Professional terms

persistent agent	agentic workflow
identity and access management (IAM)	least-privilege access
audit trail	human-in-the-loop
completed-task rate	inference cost
capital expenditure	supply-chain bottleneck
capacity commitment	institutional distribution
custody risk	hot wallet
wallet segmentation	redemption mechanism
counterparty risk	regulatory arbitrage
geofencing	

Today's big picture

Today's AI story is moving from features to commitments. Persistent agents require stronger governance because they can act beyond a single prompt, while multiyear compute contracts show how much capital and planning sit behind the service. The durable winners will combine useful automation with explicit controls and reliable capacity.

Crypto faces the same operational test. A wallet incident measures the quality of custody and recovery processes, while the Polymarket lawsuit measures the durability of a distribution model under local law. In both cases, infrastructure only scales when risk, responsibility and legal permissions are clear.